

i heard this story from my friend who'd been catching me up on stuff since i'd been away:

x and **y** have been together since any of us have known them. we'd all gone to uni together (at least most of us had) and they'd been together since then. a couple of years ago we found out **x** was transitioning which is completely fine. it's your body, whatever you wanna do, however you feel, i'll support you. so that was going on in the background as we were moving to London, getting work, living together, moving in, moving out, that sort of stuff. everyone was doing their own thing, years went by, and **x** transitioned. Yay **x**!

there was no big deal made out of it, no party or whatever, it just happened gradually, everyone was respectful and **x** is so lovely anyway why wouldn't you be supportive of him. so all was good and everyone was just getting along.

then i went away for work. six months, amazing opportunity, amazing experience. difficult, but super fulfilling. when I got back, i went for drinks with one of our friends who filled me in with what i'd missed since being away.

apparently, kinda out of nowhere **y** (**x**'s girlfriend) broke down to one of our other friends on a night-out, saying that she was miserable and super depressed and anxious. and after like an hour or so of trying to coax out what exactly was wrong with **y**, **y** kinda intimated that she'd fallen out of love with **x** since the transition.

now obviously this is huge, and our friend was (quite rightly) taken aback by it. heavy conversation to be having; sequestered in the corner of a club, when everyone is loaded. anyway our friend (and this isn't great) kinda extricated themselves from the situation, 'cause it was just too much to deal with drunk and rolling after a week of work. They went their separate ways at the end of the night, and then nothing. nothing for like a week or something.

then our friend gets this email from **y** that's like half 'so-so sorry - completely unreasonable to blindsides you with this'; half explaining more coherently the reasons why **y** feels she'd fallen out of love with **x** which, even written down in a sober, thought-out email, were super complex and nuanced and just kinda hard for our friend to get their head around, sitting at their computer working, or at lunch over a salad or whatever.

so our friend starts stressing out about it and starts growing to fear this email, fearing the details of **x** and **y**'s relationship issues that had been kinda forced upon them to mediate. so they kinda (and again this isn't great) they kinda ignored the email. i mean, ~~she~~ they know they didn't handle the situation at all great, but they just kinda felt overcome by the gravity of the whole thing, and i mean they're in therapy now themselves over this whole thing, like it's really done a number on them.

anyway so eventually this all comes out. **x** asked everyone to meet up for drinks so he could explain the situation. they all go (i'm still away at this point) and **x** tells them what **y** told him: that there were certain aspects of **x** that were lost now he had transitioned; little indefinable bits of him that had been kinda rubbed out or made less prominent. and whilst it absolutely killed her to do (like she's unsure she'll ever get over it, is what she at least told **x**) she couldn't be with someone she didn't love.

and she'd tussled and tussled with it, and talked to her family and the friends who would listen, and had realised in all honesty that whilst she completely supported **x**'s decision to transition (like what sort of monster wouldn't support someone - who felt wholeheartedly that they were born into the wrong body - in the decision to transition into the right one; a body that they were comfortable in - like what sort of monster wouldn't support that?). whilst **y** completely supported his decision, she (and this was awful for her to admit; like

'you're a terrible person and you're gonna burn in hell' awful) she just wasn't in love with this new person **x** was.

x was telling everyone this: saying how **y** had been crying and in periodic hysterics; and my friend was telling me this: saying how **x** just looked super sad and kinda defeated and that the whole scene was kinda just fucked. like 'no-one knows what to say', 'no-one knows how even to begin fixing this situation' FUCKED.

that was like a month ago. no-one's talked to **y**, though a few people have reached out. she probably needs time. we've all been trying to just be super supportive to **x** at the moment. some people think he should get back out there. i dunno, it still seems super raw to me. He's still got this kinda super sad defeated expression whenever i've seen him since coming back (which has only been like one or two times, works been crazy since i got back).

i dunno. if i'm being honest (and I know it sounds bad) the whole thing is super draining and causing me (and everyone I talk to) a load of anxiety. sometimes something just happens that catches you completely off guard and tips your entire reality on its head. i've thought that kind of thing had happened to me a load in my life, but it never really had, not until this. i just feel terrible for them both. it's just really, really sad.

and I know its selfish of me to think but down deep at the bottom of it I really just hope we can all get out of the other side of this completely fucked situation and all still be friends. so dumb to be thinking of myself at this point but it's true. there's a part of me that just wishes it hadn't happened. and again I know its like super horrible to think (and i'd never tell anyone this cause i'd be scared of how they'd look at me when I told them); and maybe

it means i'm a horrible person too, even to have these kind of thoughts; but there's a part of me that wished i didn't even know any of this; that I didn't go for drinks with my friend; and that I never came back.